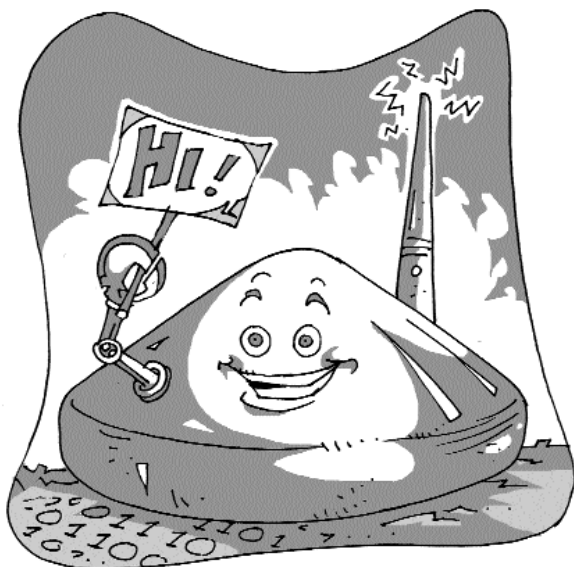


Wireless: The Basics



Wireless technology has pervaded our lives—mobile phones, cordless phones, and infrared remote control devices are just a few examples of the wireless devices we use. This book will steer clear of consumer electronics and mass communication devices, which use infrared, cellular and satellite transmission technologies, and stick to the definition of wireless in Information Technology (IT): “To establish communication without the use of cables or wires, where data distribution occurs through an unguided medium such as the atmosphere, by using radio wave technologies.”

Wireless devices can be used both by businesses and individuals. This book will focus on the individual, and address our personal needs and possible deployments of wireless. The most basic use for wireless is to set up a Wireless Local Area Network (WLAN) or Personal Area Network (PAN) at home. This can be achieved by using wireless technologies and protocols such as Wi-Fi and Bluetooth.